

Complete BrightHR Platform Analysis

2.1 Platform Overview

BrightHR is a UK-based SaaS HR management platform serving SMEs. It operates as a modular suite of applications under the "Bright Apps" umbrella. The core platform is accessible at app.brighthr.com and has companion mobile apps for iOS and Android.

The Bright Apps Ecosystem

🔗 *BrightHR (Core)*

- Core HR services — the main platform
- Employee management & profiles
- Leave & absence management
- Payroll integration

🛡️ *BrightSafe*

- Health & Safety support module
- Incident reporting
- Risk assessments
- Safety documentation

📦 *Bright BRAINBOX+ (AI)*

- AI-powered HR, H&S and payroll advice
- 50+ years employment law knowledge base
- Redundancy Navigator tool
- Available 24/7

🛒 *BrightExchange*

- Free online marketplace for employees
- Discount offers from major retailers
- Employee wellbeing perks
- Partner brand offers

💰 *Pop (Expenses)*

- Expense & mileage tracking
- Approval workflow
- Categorisation & tagging

- CSV export capability
□ *Blip (Clock-Ins)*
- Real-time clock-in/out system
- GPS geofencing
- QR code clock-in
- Break tracking
♥ *Wisdom Lite*
- Employee health & wellbeing app
- Mental health resources
- Wellbeing tracking
- Available on mobile only
♣ *BrightAdvice*
- HR & Employment law advice
- Available on mobile app stores
- Phone advice line
- Legal expert access

3. BrightHR Feature Inventory — Complete Module Breakdown

CORE

Feature	Sub-Features	How It Works
People Overview Widget	Who's absent, Working status, Who's clocked in	Real-time view of employees, Leave, Sickness, TOIL, etc.
My Summary Panel	Leave balance, Overtime summary, E-learning progress	Personal dashboard with leave, overtime and e-learning course progress

AI BRAINBOX+ Widget	Natural language HR/H&S/Payroll Q&A	Embedded AI chatbot on dashboard. No cost to user
Calendar Quick View	Absence calendar snapshot, View calendar link	Shows upcoming absences
BrightExchange Widget	Rotating discount offers from partner brands	Carousel of employee offers
Quick Actions Panel	Add time off (4 types), HR documents, Log overtime, Use TOIL, Add employees, Manage teams, Add job	Slide-out panel from navigation Reduces navigation clicks
Notifications	Absence requests, system alerts, pending actions	Bell icon with badge count
Mobile App Links	iOS App Store, Google Play Store	Persistent links to download
What's New	Product changelog, new feature announcements	Badge count on top navigation

CORE

Feature	Sub-Features
Employee Directory	Teams View, List View, Filter by All/Team, Sort A-Z/Z-A/Start Date, Status filter

Manage Teams	Create teams, assign employees, team hierarchies
Vaccinated Employees	VaccTrak — vaccination status tracking
Annual Leave Balance	Overview of all employees' leave balances
Employee Profile — Absence Tab	All absences, Annual leave, Lateness, Sickness, Other; Date range filter; Absence history (current/past); Add absence buttons
Employee Profile — Employment Tab	Contract info, Employment type (Fixed/Casual/Zero Hours), Entitlement unit (Days/Hours), Contracted hours, Working time patterns, Place of work, Public holidays, Annual leave settings, Employment summary, Role information, Salary info, Payroll info, Bank details, Sensitive information, External employee reference
Employee Profile — Overtime Tab	Overtime requests, TOIL balance
Employee Profile — Personal Tab	Personal details, emergency contacts, demographics
Employee Profile — Emergencies Tab	Emergency contact name, relationship, phone

Employee Profile — Documents Tab	Per-employee documents, upload/download
Working Status	Set working status (Working from usual location, Remote, Off-site, etc.)
Quick View	Hover quick view on employee cards

CORE

Feature	Sub-Features	How
Calendar View	Month view, Team filter, Absence type colour coding (Annual Leave, Sickness, Lateness, TOIL, Other, Pending)	Visual Navig
Pending Requests	Approve/Decline leave requests, Badge count	Separ badg
Mandatory Leave	Add mandatory leave dates, employee notification	Set co emph
Sync Feature	Sync calendar to external calendar apps	"Sync
Add Time Off	Annual leave, Sickness, Lateness, Other absence with employee selector, date range, notes	Quick imme

Annual Leave & Holiday Pay Compliance	Legal requirement tracking (6 years), Fair Work Agency compliance	Built-System
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CORE

Feature	Sub-Features	How It Works
Active Rotas	Create new rota, Filter by date range/name, Sort options	List of all active rotas
Old Rotas	Archive of past rotas	Historical rota archive
Shifts Management	View shifts by date range, Filter by name/rota/label, Show shifts for Everyone/Me	Central shift view
Create Rota	Rota builder with staff assignment	Step-by-step rota creation, share with employees
Rota Settings	Restricted permissions, Hide shift labels, Shift accept/decline, Open shifts, Auto-publish	Admin controls for rota management, labels. Enable open shifts
Rota Report	Hours worked summary, Shift breakdown report, Downloadable	Generate rota reports
Auto-share with Employees	Published rotas automatically shared via app/email	When a rota is published, employees receive notifications.

Open Shifts	Create open shifts for employee self-assignment	Admin/manager creation required.
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CORE

Feature	Sub-Features	How It Works
Who's In (Live Dashboard)	Clocked In count, On a Break count, Clocked Out count; Filter by employee/location; Print capability	Real-time employee location
Timesheets	Weekly view, Employee list, Contracted vs actual hours, Clock-in total, Variance, Payable overtime, Absence, Start/End/Total/Location columns, Show breaks toggle	Weekly Automated timesheet generation
Clock-in History	Historical clock-in records per employee	Audit trail
Clock-in Locations	Define locations, Set geofence radius, QR code generation	Create geofences for location tracking
Blip Settings	Web clock-in enable/disable, Manual entries, Geofence mode (Onsite/Flexible/Flexible clock-out/Employee specific)	Granular control over clock-in settings
Manual Entries	Admin/employee manual time entry	Allow for manual time entry

CORE

Feature	Sub-Features	How It Works
Document Library (Folder System)	Admin documents, My documents, My pay documents, Team folders, Company folder, Terminated folder	Hierarchical folder structure pay documents = payslips
Document Upload	Upload files, Set expiry dates, Search	Upload any file type. Set expiry dates across all folders.
Document Reports	Sensitive information report (expiry tracking)	Report showing all documents
Pay Documents	Payslip storage, integration with payroll	Payslips automatically filed as pay documents.
Create Report	Document report generation	Generate a report of all documents
Per-Employee Documents	Documents accessible via employee profile	Each employee profile has a document list

PREMIUM

Feature	Sub-Features	How It Works
Goals	My Goals, All Goals, Create goal, Search by name, Filter by Status/Assignee	Set and track individual goals Progress, Completed

Reviews	Assigned to me, Manage cycles, Templates; Not complete / Completed filter; Create review cycle; Create review template; FAQ help	Structured performance review templates with custom questions
Review Templates	Custom question builder for review forms	Build reusable templates for consistency.
Review Cycles	Schedule-based review management	Define review periods

PREMIUM

Feature	Sub-Features	How It Works
CPD-Accredited Courses	Access from anywhere, 24/7 availability	Integrate with GLU Premium e-learning content for compliance training, skills development, legal training.
Learning Management System	Track team progress, Course completion certificates	Fully integrated LMS. Monitor progress automatically.
Mandatory Training Tracking	Compliance training management	Assign mandatory courses (e.g., safety training).
Dashboard Summary	E-learning progress visible on dashboard "My Summary" widget	Employee can see their e-learning progress

CORE

Feature	Sub-Features	Report Description
Absence Report	Date range, employee filter	Breakdown of taken, pending, car
Annual Leave Summary	Entitlement, taken, remaining	Full breakdown of annual leave ta
Blip Timesheet Report	Clock-in/out data, hours	Timesheet report generated from
Employee Details Report	Full employee data export	Complete breakdown of all inform
Employee Information Report	All employees summary	Summary of personal and contrac
Furloughed Employees Report	Furlough status tracking	Summary of employees on furlou
Lateness Report	Period selection	Track employee lateness over a se
Length of Service Report	Tenure calculation	Calculates length of service for all
Overtime Report	Pending/declined breakdown	Detailed breakdown of pending a
Payroll Exceptions Report	Absence data for payroll	All absence records formatted for

Pop Expenses Report	Expense claims	Expense report across all team members
Rota Report	Hours worked, shift details	Summary or detailed breakdown of hours
Sensitive Information Report	Document expiry tracking	Expiry dates of sensitive employee documents
Sickness Report	Sickness rate, cost calculation	Measure sickness rate and calculate costs
Turnover & Retention Report	Leavers over a period	Summary of employees leaving or returning
VaccTrak Report	Vaccination status	Clear report of vaccination status
Working Status Report	Current working location status	Summary of who has set a working location
Custom Reports (Beta)	Build, save, download custom reports	Custom report builder using any of our reports

CORE

Feature	Sub-Features	How It Works
Payroll Dashboard	Active pay runs, Complete missing info alerts, Talk to payroll expert button	Overview of active pay runs, payroll expert advice.

Pay Runs	Monthly/weekly pay schedules, Parallel run mode, Lock/unlock runs	Configure pay frequency changes.
Payroll Employees	Employee payroll records, bank details, salary info	Employee-level payroll
Overtime (Payroll)	Overtime calculations in payroll	Overtime logged in HR
Audit Trail	Payroll change history	Full audit log of all pay
Payroll Import	Import external payroll data	Import payroll data from
PAYE Settings	PAYE configuration for HMRC compliance	Configure PAYE settings
BrightHR Payroll	Fully managed payroll service	Optional fully managed

INTEGRATED APP

Feature	Sub-Features	How It Works
Expense Claims	My Expenses, Approvals tab, Add new claim	Employees submit claims, queue (Approval)

Expense Filtering	Date range, Employee filter, Category/tag filter, Status filter (Pending/Approved/Declined/Paid)	Comprehensive
Approval Workflow	Approve, Decline, Mark as paid, Revert to pending	Multi-step option for
Export	Export to CSV	Export filter
Mileage Tracking	Mileage claims with rate calculation	Submit mi

INTEGRATED APP

Feature	Sub-Features	How It Works
Job Management	Create jobs, View all jobs, Filled/Unfilled status tracking, Total jobs dashboard	Central recruitment counts.
Applicant Management	Manage applicants per job posting	Track candidates
Recruitment Resources	Job description template, Interview handbook, Offer letter template	Downloadable templates Reduce admin burden
HR Advice Integration	Recruitment-specific legal advice	Phone access to HR (background checks, etc.).

Permissions	Recruitment access control	Control which em
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PREMIUM

Feature	Sub-Features	How It Works
AI HR Advisor	Natural language Q&A for HR, H&S, payroll questions	AI chatbot with 50+ years of Available 24/7 at no extra co
Redundancy Navigator	Step-by-step redundancy guide, document library, redundancy plans	Guided process for managing Ensures fair and legal proces
Phone Advice Line	UK-based legal experts, 0844 892 3927	Direct access to employment disputes, redundancy, etc.

ADMIN

Setting Area	Options Available
Company Settings	Company name, Employee status toggle, Hide email addresses, Hide employees from each o enable/disable, TOIL settings, Absence conflict detection, Annual leave carryover, Prevent lea
Permissions	User roles: Admin, Manager, Employee; Direct reports assignment; Permission history

Point of Contact	Designate HR point of contact
Working Time Patterns	Create named work schedules (Mon-Fri 9-5, etc.) with day-by-day hours
Places of Work	Define work locations, set public holidays per location
Notifications	Configure email/push notification rules
BrightLabs	Experimental/beta features toggle
Rota Settings	Restricted permissions, Hide shift labels, Accept/decline shifts, Open shifts, Auto-activation
Blip Settings	Web clock-in, Manual entries, Geofence modes per employee
PAYE Settings	UK tax reference numbers, HMRC config